Project Atlas Charter

Purpose, authority, governance, and delivery boundaries

PROGRAM	Project Atlas
CLASSIFICATION	Internal
DOCUMENT STATUS	Approved working record

Purpose and authorization

Project Atlas is the delivery program for modernizing the company's deployment platform without interrupting customer-facing service. This charter authorizes the cross-functional team to coordinate platform engineering, release operations, security, support readiness, and customer communications through production stabilization.

The business case is operational rather than cosmetic. Release preparation currently relies on manual handoffs, and regional teams do not receive consistent readiness evidence. Atlas is intended to make those handoffs observable and repeatable while preserving existing service commitments.

Executive sponsorship sits with Jordan Lee, who will chair the monthly steering review and arbitrate cross-functional scope questions.

The steering group approved a planning envelope of $1.8 million for the current fiscal year. Finance will track vendor invoices separately from internal labor; neither the envelope nor monthly invoice variance is a delivery milestone.

Objectives and success measures

The program should shorten deployment lead time, improve the auditability of release evidence, and give operations a controlled rollback path. Success will be measured over the first two production cycles rather than on launch day alone.

The team will monitor change-failure rate, time to restore service, release-evidence completeness, and adoption by internal delivery teams. The initial service-level aspiration discussed during discovery was a fifteen-minute rollback, but the steering group did not adopt that aspiration as a committed deadline.

A billing-system replacement appeared in the 2025 discovery deck. It is explicitly outside the Atlas authorization and remains owned by the separate Finance Systems portfolio.

Governance and boundaries

The core team meets on Tuesdays for delivery coordination. A monthly steering review handles funding, policy, and material scope changes. Working-session notes may record alternatives, but only decisions identified in approved minutes or change records alter the baseline.

Customer data migration, deployment tooling, and release controls are within scope. Office network upgrades, sales compensation, and the support team's seating move are not. Teams may reuse Atlas practices elsewhere, but those adoptions are not deliverables of this charter.

The charter is effective as of July 6, 2026. A discovery checkpoint dated November 18, 2025 is retained in the appendix for historical traceability and must not be treated as a current project milestone.

Operating model

Workstream leads maintain their own task boards and bring only cross-team constraints to the program review. This keeps the charter durable while allowing implementation details to evolve.

Program communications follow the standard records policy. Drafts, chat excerpts, room bookings, and distribution lists are working material rather than authority for scope, dates, ownership, or status.

Stakeholder landscape

Atlas touches teams with different operating rhythms. Platform engineering works in two-week iterations, operations plans around maintenance windows, and customer-success teams organize work by account cohort. The program office is responsible for making cross-team dependencies visible without replacing those local systems.

Regional support leaders asked for advance notice when cohort composition changes. Legal and privacy teams need evidence that administrative exports respect retention policy. These interests shape readiness reviews, but consultation alone does not transfer delivery ownership or approve scope.

The sponsor may invite subject-matter experts to steering reviews when a decision requires specialized context. Attendance at a review should not be read as ownership of a milestone or risk.

Benefits and measurement

Benefits will be evaluated after two stable release cycles. The baseline includes manual effort spent assembling evidence, elapsed time between code-ready and deployment-ready, and the number of handoff defects found during readiness review.

The discovery team modeled a thirty-percent reduction in preparation effort. That figure is a planning hypothesis, not a delivery commitment, deadline, status, or approved outcome.

Program reporting should distinguish between leading indicators, such as checklist completion, and outcome measures, such as change-failure rate. A favorable weekly metric does not by itself change overall project status.

Change control

Any proposed change affecting an approved date, accountable owner, launch requirement, or risk treatment must be recorded through the change authority. Working groups may explore options and document tradeoffs without creating a new baseline.

The program office maintains a decision log and publishes accepted changes with their source record. Where sources disagree, the discrepancy remains visible until a human resolution is recorded; historical documents are never rewritten to manufacture consistency.